The Boat on the Note

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 12

The bank stair was roped closed. Beside it floated a broad pontoon, joined to shore by a ramp attached at both ends. Nib compared the old and new notes. Their boat pictures looked different because the landing itself had changed.

“The note has changed its boat,” Nib murmured suspiciously. “The landing changed first,” Lark explained gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **train**

“Oa in boat and coat writes long o,” Lark modeled clearly. “Ow can write long o in snow, a different sound from ow in cow. Read each example and check its meaning. We don't decide that a spelling always has its first learned sound.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try boat, coat, snow. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read boat on the current note,” Lark invited gently. “Which diagram matches the attached pontoon we can actually see?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The boat is by the dock. My coat is on the seat.**

“Where is the coat?” Lark asked softly. “Which sentence gives that information?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The boat reached the usable pontoon. Its ramp moved gently with the water while both attachments stayed secure. Nib checked the support before bringing Train toward shore. The borrower still needed the proper lending token, so the third entry remained pending in the record.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write boat beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal kept the current pontoon drawing. The old stairs stayed closed. At the quay's lending table, a coin-shaped token and a bright toy token waited for different purposes.